Vikas PD Gawai

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Employment

Postdoctoral Health Economics Research Fellow, Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC) 2024–Present

Education

PhD, Applied Economics, University of Wisconsin-Madison 2018–2024
Dissertation: "Technology in the Aging World: The Role of Broadband and Green Revolution"
Committee: Jeremy Foltz, Lauren Schmitz, John Mullahy, Jason Fletcher, Priya Mukherjee
MS, Economics, University of Wisconsin-Madison 2016–2018
Bachelor of Technology, Civil Engineering, Mumbai University 2004–2008

Publications

- **Vikas Gawai**. (2026). "Does high-speed internet (broadband) technology affect the mental health of older adults?" *Conditionally Accepted*.
- Sergey Sotnikov, Kelly Kilburn, **Vikas Gawai**, Nancy Habarta, Cassandra Frazier, and Karen Mumford. (2026). "CDC's Preventive Health and Health Services Block Grant flexible funding mechanism is associated with improved population health outcomes." *Journal of Public Health Management and Practice* (Forthcoming).
- **Vikas Gawai** and Steven Deller. (2025). "Is there a link between access to broadband and health outcomes?" *American Journal of Economics and Sociology*.
- Jeremy Foltz and **Vikas Gawai**. (2025). "Discrimination in science: Salaries of foreign and U.S.-born land-grant university scientists." *American Journal of Agricultural Economics*.
- Hamid Noghanibehambari, Jason Fletcher, Lauren Schmitz, Valentina Duque, and **Vikas Gawai**. (2024). "Early-life economic conditions and old-age male mortality: evidence from historical county-level bank deposit data." *Journal of Population Economics*.

Research Under External / Internal Review

- **Vikas Gawai**, Nancy Habarta, Ruth Gould, Sergey Sotnikov, Kristen Chapman, Caroline Sulal, Karla Checo Martinez, Hazel Dean, and Ermias Belay. (2026). "Cost efficiency of a centralized funding mechanism: Evi-

dence from CDC's National Partnership umbrella cooperative agreement."

- **Vikas Gawai**, Jessica Irizarry, Megan Harbour, Camila Rodriguez-Rojas, Hazel Dean, and Ermias Belay. (2026). "Cost efficiency analysis of CDC's centralized funding mechanism using a stochastic frontier approach: Evidence from CDC's U.S. Affiliated Pacific Islands Cooperative Agreement."
- **Vikas Gawai**, Lauren Schmitz, Valentina Duque, Jinkook Lee, and Hunter Green. "Effect of early life exposure to the Green Revolution on aging outcomes in India."
- Kanika Arora, Shubhashrita Basu, **Vikas Gawai**, Junjie Gai, and Lauren Schmitz. "Cognitive function and life-course patterns – Evidence from the Longitudinal Aging Study of India."

Working Papers

- **Vikas Gawai**, Sergey Sotnikov, Nancy Habarta, Sonal Doshi, ShauntÄ Wright, Katherine Butler Smart, Donatus U. Ekwueme, "Association between CDC's Preventive Health and Health Services Block Grant public health infrastructure investments and performance of state public health departments."
- Adrienne Gill, **Vikas Gawai**, Hannah McMillan, Deborah Bryant, Nancy Habarta, and Hazel Dean. "Association between CDC's accreditation funding and performance of state health departments."
- Donatus U. Ekwueme, **Vikas Gawai**, Sabitha Dasari, Yamisha Bermudez, Sun Hee Rim, Susan Sabatino, Janet S. de Moor, David A. Siegel, Michael T. Halpern, K. Robin Yobroff. "The evolving economic burden of cancer survivors in the United States, 2011-2024."
- **Vikas Gawai**. "Spillover effects of a bicycle policy on girls' enrollment in middle schools." (Best Research Paper, Honorable Mention)
- **Vikas Gawai**. "Effects of Teacher Hiring Policy on Students' Learning in Rural India: A Multi-Cutoff Regression Discontinuity Design Approach."
- **Vikas Gawai**. "Does Broadband Technology Affect Social Security Applications?"

Media & Impact

Internet and Mental Health, GROW Magazine Cover Story
Broadband and Social Security Applications, The Financial Findings Podcast

Technical Skills

Stata, R, Python, LaTeX, GitHub, AI Agents, MS Office

Grants, Fellowships & Awards

Diversity Fellow, School of Public Affairs, American University 2023–2024

Research Fellow, Retirement and Disability Research Center (RDRC) 2022–2024
Center for Demography of Health and Aging Research ($2,000) 2023
RDRC - Junior Scholar Research Competition Award ($5,000) 2022
Research Travel Award UW-Madison ($1,100) 2022
Deborah and David Penn Fund ($1,500) 2022–2023
UW-Madison Graduate School Award ($4,000) 2022–2023
UW-Madison Center for Demography and Ecology ($950) 2022
DEI Diversity Scholarship, American Society of Health Economics (ASHEcon) 2021
UW-Madison Traisman Agribusiness Graduate Fellowship ($750) 2021
UW-Madison Student Research Grants Competition ($1,500) 2020
UW-Madison IRIS Graduate Student Summer Fieldwork Award ($3,000) 2019
Best Research Scholarship (Honorable Mention), UW-Madison Dept. of Economics 2018
Indian State Government Scholarship for MS Economics ($100,000) 2016–2018

Teaching & Research Experience

Research Assistantships

Prof. Lauren Schmitz (UW-Madison, School of Public Affairs) 2020–2024
Prof. Jeremy Foltz (UW-Madison, Agriculture and Applied Economics) 2018–2020
Prof. Andra Ghent (UW-Madison, Wisconsin School of Business) 2018

Teaching

Econometrics Methods at CDC (CDC) 2026
Guest Lecturer, World Hunger and Malnutrition (UW-Madison) 2024
Guest Lecturer, Gender Gap and Economic Development (UW-Madison) 2022–2023
Guest Lecturer, Agricultural & Economic Development of Africa (UW-Madison) 2022
Guest Lecturer, The Economics of Race and Gender (Bentley University) 2022

Professional Service & Leadership

Editorial & Review

Associate Editor: *Preventing Chronic Disease* 2026–Present
Reviewer: *International Journal of Public Health* (2026), *Journal of Population Economics* (2025, 2026), Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (2023, 2025), Agriculture and Applied Economics Association (2022–2024), *Economics of Education Review* (2022–2023), American Society for Health Economists (2022)

Institutional Service

CDC Prevention Effectiveness Fellowship Hiring Committee 2025–2026

AAEA-Health Economics Section Official Twitter Manager	2022–2023
UW-Madison AAE Faculty Hiring Committee	2022
UW-Madison AAE Ph.D. Admission Committee	2021
Taylor-Hibbard Club, Athletic Chair	2020–2022
UW-Madison AAE Development Lab Group	2019

Mentorship

UW-Madison CDHA Research Mentor for 18 students	2022
Undergraduate Research Supervisor (2 students)	2022
Mentor, First-generation undergraduate students	2022
Mentor, First-generation underrepresented graduate students from India	2018–Present

Conferences

AcademyHealth	2026
ASHEcon	2024
Social Security Administration (SSA) Annual Meeting	2024
Data-Intensive Research Conference, University of Minnesota	2024
Midwest Economics Association	2023
Southern Economics Association	2023
Agricultural and Applied Economics Association	2022
Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management	2022–2024
Population Association of America	2022
American Education Finance and Policy Conference	2020

References

Jeremy Foltz
Agriculture and Applied Economics
University of Wisconsin-Madison
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Nancy Habarta
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NHabarta@cdc.gov

Lauren Schmitz
La Follette School of Public Affairs
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Donatus U. (Don) Ekwueme
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